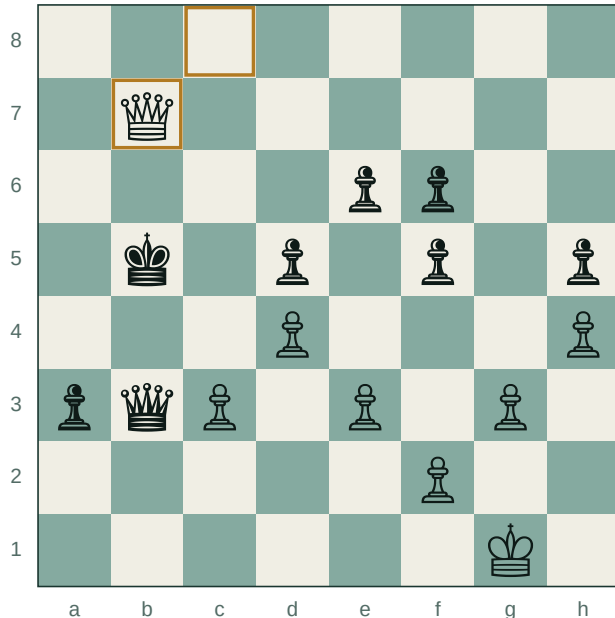


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 52

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 52.Qb7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

52...Kc4 53. Qc8+ Kd3

52...Kc4 The king moves from b5 to c4. The changed line means the queen on b3 attacks the queen on b7. Recorded reply: **53.Qc8+**.

53...Kd3 The king moves from c4 to d3.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on b7. Check for tactical protection.